Activity

Discuss in a small groups about the effects of global warming.

Wind

When air blows horizontally at or near the earth's surface is called wind. The erosional, transportational and depositional action of wind is predominant in arid regions. This is called as Aeolian Process.

Erosional Landforms of wind

Some of the erosional landforms of wind are mushroom rocks, Inselbergs and yardangs.

Mushroom Rock



Rocks are made up of hard and soft layers. When a rock's bottom is soft, the sand-laden winds blow against it and wear it down. By the constant wearing down action of the wind, the bottom gets eroded away to form a mushroom like structure. This is called a **mushroom or pedestal rock**. Such rocks are found near Jodhpur in Rajasthan.

Inselberg



Inselberg is a German term which means an **island mountain**. Certain hard rocks like igneous rocks are more resistant to wind action. Such **isolated residual hills** rising abruptly from their surroundings are termed as inselbergs. Eg. Uluru or Ayers Rock, Australia.

Yardang

In arid regions, certain rocks have hard and soft layers arranged vertically. When winds blow over these rocks, the soft layers get eroded leaving irregular crests. These are called yardangs.



Depositional Landforms of wind

Some of the depositional landforms are sand dunes, barchans and loess.

Sand Dune

In deserts, during sandstorms, wind carries loads of sand. When the speed of wind decreases, huge amount of sand gets deposited. These **mounds or hills of sand** are called sand dunes. There are different types of sand dunes.

Barchan

Barch are isolated, **crescent shaped sand dunes**. They have gentle slopes on the windward side and steep slopes on the leeward side.



Transverse Dunes

Transverse dunes are asymmetrical in shape. They are formed by alternate slow and fast winds that blow from the same direction.



Longitudinal Dunes(Seif dunes)

Longitudinal dunes are long narrow ridges of sand, which extend in a direction

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